

visAPPprot Image Search Setup

To use the Exemplar Image functionality of the visAPPprot system, you will need to set up Google Image Search access. This should take 10 minutes to complete.

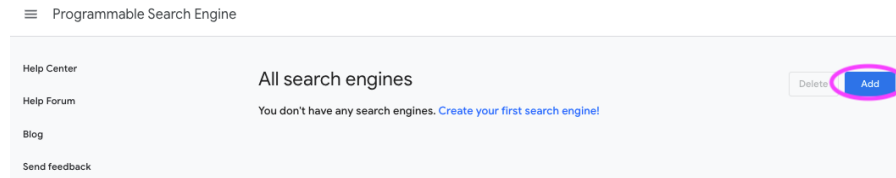
In this document you will create a Google image search engine and an API key for image search.

1. Create Image Search Server

Go to Google's Programmable Search Engine: <https://programmablesearchengine.google.com/>

If you are not signed in yet, please click on the blue "Get Started" button which will prompt you to sign into your Google account.

Click the Add button to the right of the page to create a new search engine.



Enter the details for your new search engine following the image below. Name your engine "visAPPprot" and select "Search the entire web option". For search settings, select both "Image search" and "SafeSearch". Then check "I'm not a robot" and click the Create button.

After your search engine is created you will be redirected back to the Programmable Search Engine page, this time with your new visAPPprot search engine listed. If you are not automatically redirected, click on the "Back to all search engines" button at the top. Then click on your visAPPprot search engine.

Help Center	All search engines				Delete	Add
Help Forum	☐	Name	Role	Public URL	Last updated time ↓	
Blog	☐	visAPPprot	Owner		Aug 20, 2025, 3:16 PM	
Send feedback					Rows per page 10	1-1 of 1 < >

You will see the search engine information, including the Search Engine ID. Click the “copy” symbol next to the engine ID to copy the ID.

Basic

Search engine name	visAPPprot
Description	Add description
Code	Get code
Search engine ID	 Copy
Public URL	

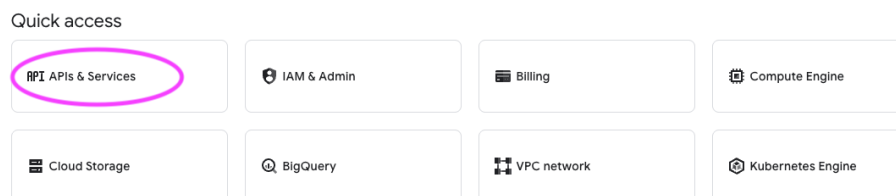
Go to your visAPPprot folder: if you are using Mac go to *Documents/visAPPprot_mac*, if you are using Windows go to *Documents/visAPPprot_windows*. Locate the *image_search.xlsx* file and open it. Replace YOUR_ENGINE_ID with the search engine ID that you just copied. Keep the spreadsheet open, but don't save it yet.

	A	B
1	CX	KEY
2	YOUR_ENGINE_ID	YOUR_API_KEY
3		

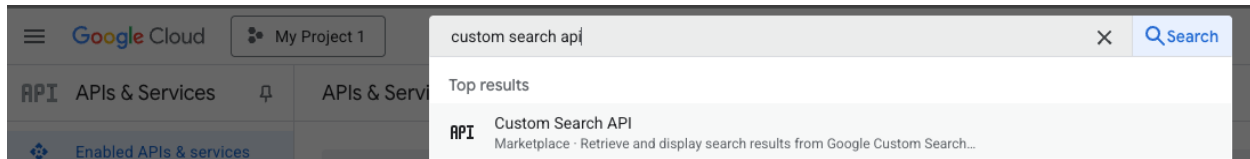
2. Generate API Key

Go to Google Cloud Console: <https://console.cloud.google.com/>

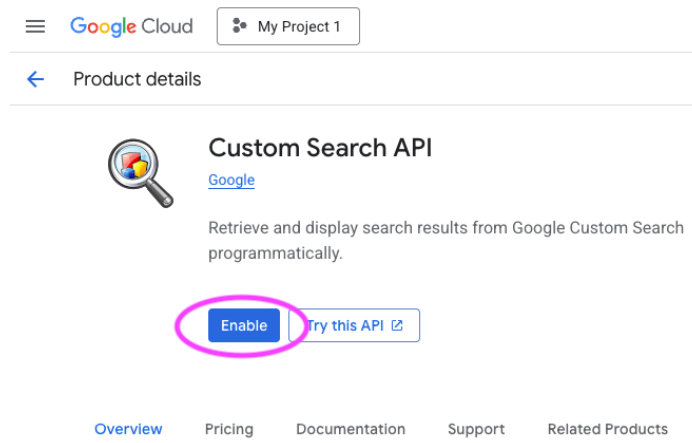
You will be prompted to log into your Google account, if you haven't already. Once you're logged in, you will see a page with these options at the bottom. Select the “APIs and Services” button.



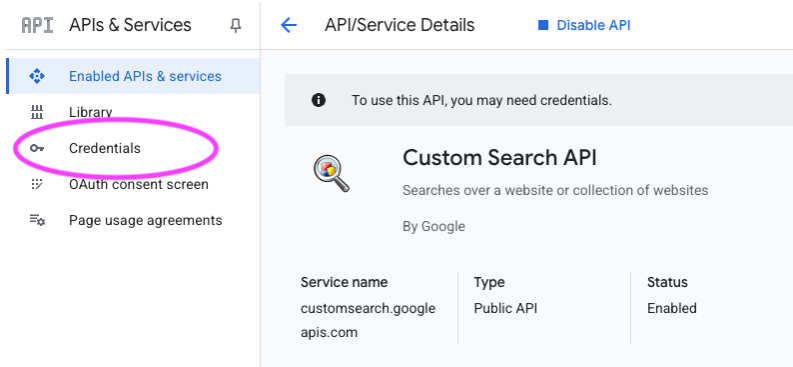
At the top of the page, type “custom search API” into the search bar. Select the result Custom Search API.



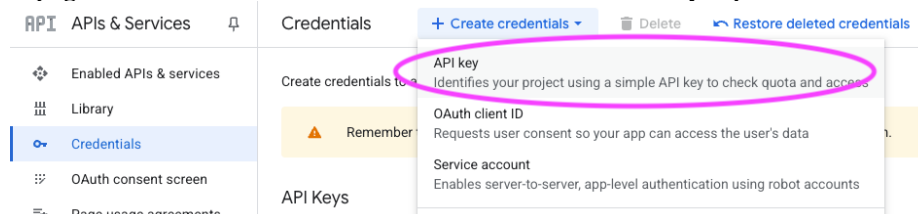
If you see the blue Enable button, click to enable Custom Search API functionality. If you see a checkmark with “API Enabled” next to it, your Custom Search API is already enabled and you can move on.



After enabling Custom Search API, click on the Credentials tab in the left sidebar. If you don’t see Credentials in your left sidebar, search for “Credentials” in the search bar at the top of the page, where we previously searched for “custom search API”.



At the top of the page click “Create credentials” and then select the “API key” option.



A popup will appear containing your API key. Click the “copy” symbol next to your API key to copy it.

